

Question Bank: Right-Sizing Your Team

Draft for review | 11 items | figures use the BrightLine example (1 rep = 6 calls an hour)

How to use this bank

These are extra items for the final check at the end of the course. The scored practice questions on screens 6, 8, 9 and 10 of the storyboard stay as they are.

Suggested setup: pull 5 questions at random, at least one per objective. Pass mark 4 out of 5, two attempts, feedback after every answer. Trainees handle 4 calls an hour where they appear.

Obj.	Objective	Questions
O1	Read a staffing ratio and say what it means	Q1, Q2
O2	Work out reps needed; split reps across queues	Q3, Q4, Q8, Q9
O3	Adjust when the forecast changes or people are off	Q5, Q6, Q7
O4	Choose an option and justify it with numbers	Q10, Q11

Questions

Q1 O1 | Multiple choice | Easy

Your roster shows 8 reps on calls. The ratio is 1 rep : 6 calls an hour. How many calls an hour can the team handle?

Answer	Feedback shown to the learner
14	You added 8 and 6. A ratio multiplies: each of the 8 reps handles 6 calls.
48 (correct)	$8 \times 6 = 48$ calls an hour.
1.3	You divided 8 by 6. To find what the team can handle, multiply reps by the calls each one takes.
6	6 is what one rep handles. There are 8 of them.

Q2 O1 | Multiple choice | Easy

What is the ratio 1 : 6 telling you at BrightLine?

Answer	Feedback shown to the learner
One rep handles about 6 calls an hour (correct)	That's it. One rep to six calls an hour.
You need 6 reps for every call	It's the other way round: it's one rep for every six calls in an hour.
A rep works 6 hours before a break	The ratio compares people to workload. It says nothing about shift length.
One team lead manages 6 reps	That's a span of control, a different kind of ratio. This one compares reps to calls.

Q3 O2 | Number entry | Medium

Thursday's forecast is 100 calls an hour. How many reps do you roster?

Answer	Feedback shown to the learner
17 (correct)	$100 \div 6 = 16.7$. You can't roster part of a person, so round up to 17.
16	16 reps handle 96 calls an hour, so 4 calls an hour go unanswered. Round up.
Any other number	Divide the forecast by what one rep handles: $100 \div 6$. Then round up.

Q4 O2 | Multiple choice | Medium

You have 21 reps on calls and the forecast is 138 calls an hour. Where do you stand?

Answer	Feedback shown to the learner
Covered, with a little to spare	$21 \times 6 = 126$, which is less than 138. You're short.
Short by 1 rep	$138 \div 6 = 23$ reps needed, and you have 21, so it's more than one.
Short by 2 reps (correct)	$138 \div 6 = 23$ needed. $23 - 21 = 2$.
Short by 12 reps	12 is the gap in calls an hour ($138 - 126$), not in reps. Divide by 6 to get 2 reps.

Q5 O3 | Number entry | Medium

10 reps are handling a forecast of 60 calls an hour. The forecast rises to 90. How many reps do you need now?

Answer	Feedback shown to the learner
15 (correct)	$90 \div 60 = 1.5$, so the team goes up by the same factor: $10 \times 1.5 = 15$.
Any other number	Both sides change by the same factor. 60 to 90 is $\times 1.5$, so multiply the 10 reps by 1.5.

Q6 O3 | Number entry | Medium

A backlog needs 72 rep-hours of work. 9 reps take 8 hours. How many hours would 12 reps take?

Answer	Feedback shown to the learner
6 (correct)	The work is fixed. $72 \div 12 = 6$ hours.
Any other number	More reps should mean fewer hours. Divide the total work, 72 rep-hours, by the number of reps.

Q7 O3 | Multiple choice | Easy

Which of these is an inverse relationship?

Answer	Feedback shown to the learner
Forecast calls go up, reps needed go up	Both go up together, so that's direct.
Reps on a backlog go up, hours to clear it go down (correct)	More people, shorter job. When one goes up the other comes down.
Reps go up, calls the team can handle go up	Both go up together, so that's direct.
Trainees go up, calls answered go up	Both go up together, so that's direct.

Q8 O2 | Three number fields | Medium

You have 24 reps to split across Voice, Chat and Email at 4 : 3 : 1. How many in each queue?

Answer	Feedback shown to the learner
Voice 12, Chat 9, Email 3 (correct)	$4 + 3 + 1 = 8$, and $24 \div 8 = 3$ reps a part. So 12, 9 and 3.
Numbers that don't add to 24	Your queues add up to [X], not 24. Add the parts first, then divide the total by that sum.
Numbers that add to 24 but are wrong	Check the size of one part: 24 divided by the sum of the parts. Then multiply each part by it.

Q9 O2 | Multiple choice | Medium

A colleague splits 20 reps at 5 : 3 : 2 and puts 5 on Voice, 3 on Chat and 2 on Email. What went wrong?

Answer	Feedback shown to the learner
They didn't divide the total by the sum of the parts (correct)	5, 3 and 2 are parts, not reps. Add the parts (10), divide 20 by 10, then multiply. That gives 10, 6 and 4.
They used the wrong ratio	The ratio is fine. The method isn't.
They should have rounded up	No rounding needed here. 20 divides exactly by 10.
Nothing, it's correct	That split only places 10 of the 20 reps.

Q10 O4 | Scenario, best answer | Hard

Monday: the forecast is 90 calls an hour, so you need 15 reps, but only 13 are in. Two trainees are free (4 calls an hour each). The email team of 8 is clearing a 48 rep-hour backlog due by the end of the 8-hour shift. What's your plan?

Answer	Feedback shown to the learner
Leave the trainees out because they're slower	$13 \times 6 = 78$ against 90, so 12 calls an hour go unanswered. The trainees would help.
Use both trainees on calls (correct)	$13 \times 6 = 78$, plus $2 \times 4 = 8$, is 86 against 90. You're 4 calls an hour short, under one rep, and nothing else suffers. Best option.
Move 2 reps from email to calls	Calls are covered: $15 \times 6 = 90$. But email drops to 6 people and $48 \div 6 = 8$ hours, exactly the whole shift with no slack. Acceptable, partial credit.
Move 2 reps and use the trainees	That overshoots (98 calls an hour against 90) and slows the backlog for no reason.

Scoring: full credit for option 2, partial credit for option 3, none for the others.

Q11 O4 | Scenario | Medium

Wednesday: the forecast is 60 calls an hour, so you need 10 reps, but 12 are on calls. The email team of 8 is working through a 48 rep-hour backlog. What's a sensible use of the 2 spare reps?

Answer	Feedback shown to the learner
Send them home early	That's possible, but the ratio says calls need 10, and there's a backlog waiting. You'd be wasting 2 people.
Move them to the email backlog (correct)	The email team becomes 10 people. $48 \div 10 = 4.8$ hours instead of 6, so the backlog finishes about 1.2 hours sooner.
Keep them on calls just in case	10 reps already cover 60 calls an hour. The extra 2 do more good on the backlog.